

Selecting Securities (Users)

Due to the specialness of securities (commodities), both on the technical level and on the business-logic level, there are several things you must understand/keep in mind before working with them.

In a nutshell, it boils down to the following:

- *Technical level:* Prices have no technical IDs in KMyMoney. Instead, they are technically selected with a (pseudo-)technical ID, consisting of a from-security-ID/currency-ID, a to-currency and a date.
- *Business-logic level:*
 - *Prices:* Humans (as opposed to machines) tend to identify a price by the above-mentioned triple.
 - *Securities:* In the real world out there, you normally would identify a security not by the internal technical ID your system (KMyMoney) identifies it with, but rather by its public security code, which hopefully you have used when entering the security in the KMyMoney file:
 - * If you live in the US or Canada, then you would typically use the 1-to-4-char ticker (such as “T” for AT&T or “MSFT” for Microsoft). But strictly speaking, this is not enough. It always has to be qualified with the according exchange (such as “NYSE_AMERICAN” (formerly known as “AMEX”) or “NASDAQ”). (The pros among you might use the CUSIP instead.)
 - * If you live outside of the US and Canada, then you would typically use something else. In the EU, where the current maintainer lives, people typically use the ISIN (international). In Germany, the nostalgic folks prefer the WKN. Similarly, in the rest of Europe: The SEDOL (UK) or the VALOR (Switzerland), etc. etc.

Overview

Figure 1 shows the two levels of price IDs in KMyMoney.

In theory, the two layers are clearly separated, i.e. technical IDs and business-logic ID do not have anything to do with each other. However, the KMyMoney developers chose to make things a little more complicated: They intentionally blurred the line between the two layers, so that technical IDs are, in fact, pseudo-technical and quasi-business.

If they had chosen to treat prices as any other entity in KMyMoney, then the technical ID would look something like this: Q000023. This string obviously has almost no meaning, i.e. it cannot / shall not be “interpreted” or “understood”

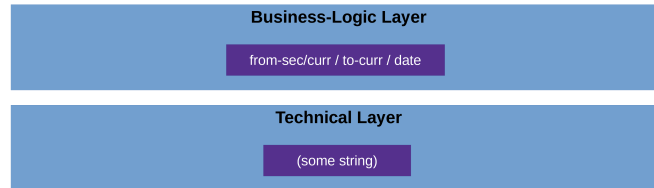


Figure 1: ID layers in KMyMoney

apart from the type defined by the prefix **Q**.¹

Well, they chose another approach: In KMyMoney, a (pseudo-)technical ID looks something like these:

- **USD:EUR** at 2022-06-02 → **USD:EUR:2022-06-02** (price of USD in EUR at given date)
- **E000001:EUR** at 2023-12-01 → **E000001:EUR:2023-12-01** (price of security in EUR at given date)

(i.e., the pair **<from-sec-curr>:<to-curr>**, which leads to a list of dates from which to choose, so together a triple).

Just by glancing at these, you can see that they are essentially business-logic IDs masquerading as technical ones; they do mean something (i.e., they have semantics) and can thus very well be interpreted and understood.

It is important to understand this (non-)difference between technical and business-logic IDs in KMyMoney before reading the next section; otherwise it will probably confuse you.

¹Every entity's ID has a prefix in KMyMoney, except the price, of course. So the 'Q' (for quote) does not actually exist, and 'P' (for price) is used for payees.

Using the Tools

We use the test data file provided with module “API Extensions”.² For test and illustration purposes, we have put securities into this file using various different systems (i.e., name spaces) – something you normally would not do in real life.

We have provided a wrapper script for the according tool: `::TODO`

Then, you have several options:

- Specifying the security by its (pseudo-)technical ID (directly), using the syntax `<from-sec-curr>:<to-curr>:<date>`.

This approach always works, but does not leverage the pre-defined name spaces. In case of an error, you won’t get precise logs and could possibly spend a lot of time finding it.

Example:

```
$ kmm_get_prc_info.sh \  
-f test.kmy \  
-psm ID \  
-pssm DIRECT \  
-prc USD:EUR:2022-06-02
```

or

```
$ kmm_get_prc_info.sh \  
-f test.kmy \  
-psm ID \  
-pssm DIRECT \  
-prc E000001:EUR:2023-12-01
```

In essence, with the direct method, we kind of “stubbornly” pretend not to know that the “technical” ID is, in fact, a business-logic ID. Instead, we see the ID as just an unnecessarily long string that has no further meaning.

The advantage of this “stubborn” approach is that you can use all provided tools somewhat symmetrically (remember that all other entities in KMyMoney do have genuine technical IDs).

- Specifying the security by its (pseudo-)technical ID (indirectly), using the various command line options.

This approach leverages the `JKMyMoneyLib`’s built-in type-safety early in the execution and will thus lead to far more precise error logs in case of an error.

Example:

²The test data files of the other modules will almost certainly work as well – they all are very similar.

```
$ kmm_get_prc_info.sh \
  -f test.kmy \
  -psm ID \
  -pssm INDIRECT \
  -fsc CURRENCY:USD \
  -tc CURRENCY:EUR \
  -dat 2022-06-02
```

or

```
$ kmm_get_prc_info.sh \
  -f test.kmy \
  -psm ID \
  -pssm INDIRECT \
  -fsc SECURITY:E000001 \
  -tc CURRENCY:EUR \
  -dat 2022-06-02
```

Notice the prefixes CURRENCY and SECURITY. They are not optional.

In essence, with the indirect method, we “acknowledge” the semantics of the pseudo-technical ID, as opposed the the direct method.

(It is worth mentioning that the type-safety-advantage is not really that important in cases like these, at least if you look narrowly at it. But once you look at the bigger picture, you will see that there is another reason why the current maintainer chose to support both variants: In order to maintain symmetry/ keep things consistent between this mechanism and the way you specify security IDs in the sister project; Notice that in JGnuCashLibNTools, there actually is a more pronounced difference between the pros and cons of both methods. Cf. the sister project’s user documentation for details).

- Specifying the security by its business logic ID (the field “Code” in KMy-Money lingo), i.e. its ISIN, CUSIP, SEDOL or similar official security identifiers (without name-space prefix).

This approach obviously only works when you actually have filled the field “Code”. However, once you have your data in order, it is the most convenient method.

Example:

```
$ kmm_get_prc_info.sh \
  -f test.kmy \
  -psm ISIN_CURR_DATE \
  -is DE000BASF111 \
  -cur EUR \
  -dat 2022-06-02
```

Notice that – for the time being – the exact same command is used when you have CUSIPs, SEDOLs, WKNs or something else in your “Code” field instead of ISINs. Still the above notation with “ISIN” etc. is used.^[4]

::TODO Select by name (not recommended but possible for `get_prc_info`, and not supported for `upd_sec`).